

Mara Ravensworth

Character Dossier

Stubborn, principled and tired fortune teller of Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn

Overview

Mara Ravensworth is a fortune teller living in Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn. Mara is 59 years old, originally from Little Ashby, and is known around Ring Deck 4 as stubborn, principled and tired. In conversation Mara uses trade jargon and then patiently explains it.

Background

Mara arrived in Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn 15 years ago after leaving Little Ashby under circumstances Mara describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Oryn Extraction Consortium; the second was the one that stuck. Today Mara works as a fortune teller near the hydroponics bay and is paid, when paid at all, in station credits.

Mara learned the trade from Noor Thornbury, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Mara's life is with Sable Marchetti, over a matter neither will explain. The person Mara trusts most is Nadira Hartwell.

Current goal: to teach one apprentice who actually listens. Greatest fear: open water.

Personality and speech

Temperament: stubborn, principled and tired.

Speech pattern: Mara uses trade jargon and then patiently explains it.

Tells: when lying, Mara mentions Fidget the cat for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Mara Ravensworth
<i>Role</i>	fortune teller
<i>Home</i>	Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn
<i>Hometown</i>	Little Ashby
<i>Age</i>	59
<i>Favourite dish</i>	grandmother's oat and ale bread
<i>Pet</i>	Fidget, a cat
<i>Lucky number</i>	467

<i>Workshop password</i>	copper-reed
<i>Mentor</i>	Noor Thornbury
<i>Rival</i>	Sable Marchetti
<i>Closest friend</i>	Nadira Hartwell

Secret

Mara once forged a letter of passage for a stranger who turned out to be a wanted person, and still keeps the copy.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Mara: I am the fortune teller. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Mara: Grandmother's oat and ale bread. Do not tell Sable I said so.

Visitor: Is Fidget yours?

Mara: Fidget belongs to nobody. Fidget tolerates me. Lucky number is 467, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 7

Mara closed early, walked to the hydroponics bay, and watched the lights come on. Fidget followed at a distance. the Oryn Extraction Consortium sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Mara read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. the Oryn Extraction Consortium sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Mara read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about the tax on doors reached Dockmaster's Row. Mara pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 2, spring of year 7

Rumours about the old tunnels reached Ring Deck 4. Mara pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Mara found a hand bell half-buried near Ring Deck 4 and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Mara repaired the spool of wire at Ring Deck 4 for Xanthe, who paid in 69 station credits and a long story about the quarantine. Leocadia came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Mara said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 3, summer of year 7

Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Mara suspects Nadira and is probably right. Mara spent the day counting stock at the hydroponics bay: 20 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short. Rumours about the harvest count reached the hydroponics bay. Mara pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 4, winter of year 7

Rumours about the tariff on salt reached Dockmaster's Row. Mara pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Mara found a iron kettle half-buried near Dockmaster's Row and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. the Oryn Extraction Consortium sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Mara read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 5, spring of year 7

At the ore refinery, Mara taught Nadira how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone. Mara was hired to carry a sextant from the ore refinery to the hydroponics bay without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Mara repaired the cracked compass at the ore refinery for Qadira, who paid in 33 station credits and a long story about the price of lamp oil. Mara won 68 station credits from Sable on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on grandmother's oat and ale bread.

Entry 6, winter of year 7

Mara spent the day counting stock at Ring Deck 4: 62 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short. At Ring Deck 4, Mara taught Nadira how to tell a real sextant from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Mara suspects Nadira and is probably right. Mara spent the day counting stock at Ring Deck 4: 72 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached Ring Deck 4. Mara pretended not to

care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 7, winter of year 7

A stranger asked Mara for the password to the workshop. Mara laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Mara moved the sextant indoors, fed Fidget, and wrote three lines to Noor about the missing shipment. A stranger asked Mara for the password to the workshop. Mara laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 8, spring of year 7

Mara repaired the ledger at the observation lounge for Octavia, who paid in 67 station credits and a long story about the quarantine. Mara spent the day counting stock at the observation lounge: 78 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short. Mara was hired to carry a copper pipe from the observation lounge to Dockmaster's Row without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 9, spring of year 8

Mara was hired to carry a sextant from the ore refinery to Ring Deck 4 without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Mara found a sack of salt half-buried near the ore refinery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Mara repaired the cracked compass at the ore refinery for Eamon, who paid in 5 station credits and a long story about the quarantine. Mara was hired to carry a ledger from the ore refinery to Ring Deck 4 without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 10, winter of year 8

Mara won 9 station credits from Sable on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on grandmother's oat and ale bread. Noor visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. Mara found a bundle of letters half-buried near the ore refinery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 11, autumn of year 8

Noor visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Oryn Extraction Consortium sent a notice about the quarantine. Mara read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Mara won 44 station credits from Sable on a bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on grandmother's oat and ale bread. Mara closed early, walked to the hydroponics bay, and watched the lights come on. Fidget followed at a distance.

Entry 12, summer of year 8

Mara closed early, walked to the ore refinery, and watched the lights come on. Fidget followed at a distance. Noor visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Mara for the password to the workshop. Mara laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Mara won 38 station credits from Sable on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on grandmother's oat and ale bread.

Entry 13, autumn of year 9

Someone left a clockwork bird on the doorstep with no note. Mara suspects Nadira and is probably right. At Dockmaster's Row, Mara taught Nadira how to tell a real tin whistle from a fake one by weight alone. Mara won 43 station credits from Sable on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on grandmother's oat and ale bread. the Oryn Extraction Consortium sent a notice about the comet. Mara read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached Dockmaster's Row. Mara pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 14, spring of year 9

Mara won 51 station credits from Sable on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on grandmother's oat and ale bread. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Mara and Sable outside the ore refinery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the ore refinery. Mara pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 15, spring of year 9

Ravi came by asking about the tariff on salt. Mara said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about the old tunnels reached the observation lounge. Mara pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Mara closed early, walked to the ore refinery, and watched the lights come on. Fidget followed at a distance. Mara repaired the cracked compass at the observation lounge for Vesna, who paid in 10 station credits and a long story about the census. Mara spent the day counting stock at the observation lounge: 37 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short.

Entry 16, winter of year 9

At the hydroponics bay, Mara taught Nadira how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Nadira came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Mara said nothing useful and made tea instead. Noor visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the comet flared up between Mara and Sable outside the hydroponics bay; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Mara for the password to the workshop. Mara laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 17, winter of year 10

Mara found a wax seal half-buried near the ore refinery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Mara closed early, walked to the observation lounge, and watched the lights come on. Fidget followed at a distance. Mara closed early, walked to the observation lounge, and watched the lights come on. Fidget followed at a distance.

Entry 18, summer of year 10

A stranger asked Mara for the password to the workshop. Mara laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Mara suspects Nadira and is probably right. The weather turned. Mara moved the tin whistle indoors, fed Fidget, and wrote three lines to Noor about who really won the regatta. At the observation lounge, Mara taught Nadira how to tell a real bundle of letters from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 19, summer of year 10

Mara closed early, walked to the observation lounge, and watched the lights come on. Fidget followed at a distance. the Oryn Extraction Consortium sent a notice about the tax on doors. Mara read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Mara closed early, walked to the observation lounge, and watched the lights come on. Fidget followed at a distance. The weather turned. Mara moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Fidget, and wrote three lines to Noor about the singing at the docks. Tallulah came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Mara said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 20, autumn of year 10

Rumours about the quarantine reached the hydroponics bay. Mara pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Mara for the password to the workshop. Mara laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Mara found a clockwork bird half-buried near the hydroponics bay and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.